

Jiazhou Chen

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Education

Ph.D. in Computational Neuroscience

2020-2025

UCL-NIMH Joint Doctoral Training Program in Neuroscience

Supervised by Prof. Quentin Huys (UCL, Primary), Prof. Argyris Stringaris (NIMH, UCL), Dr. Dylan Nielson (NIMH)
University College London (UCL), London, U.K.

National Institute of Mental Health, Bethesda, MD, USA

Bachelor of Science in Psychology (Honors) & Bachelor of Arts in Economics

2014-2017

The University of Texas at Austin, Austin, TX, USA

Research Experience

Postdoctoral Fellow

2025 - Present

Unit on Computational Decision Neuroscience (P.I. Siliva Lopez-Guzman)

Emotion and Development Branch, National Institute of Mental Health, Bethesda, MD, USA

PhD Student / Predoctoral Fellow

2020 - 2025

Applied Computational Psychiatry Lab (P.I. Prof. Quentin Huys)

Division of Psychiatry, University College London, U.K.

Max Planck UCL Centre for Computational Psychiatry and Aging Research, University College London, U.K.

Emotion and Development Branch (P.I. Prof. Argyris Stringaris, Dr. Daniel Pine)

National Institute of Mental Health, Bethesda, MD, USA

Research Programmer / Analyst

2017 - 2020

Decision Neuroscience and Psychopathology Lab (P.I. Prof. Alexander Dombroski)

Department of Psychiatry, University of Pittsburgh Medical Center, Pittsburgh, PA, USA

Translational Neuropsychopharmacology & Neuroimaging Lab (P.I. Dr. Marta Peciña)

Department of Psychiatry, University of Pittsburgh Medical Center, Pittsburgh, PA, USA

Teaching Experience

Post Graduate Teaching Assistant

University College London, U.K.

Publications

Onysk, J.*, **Chen, J.***, & Huys, Q. J. (2026). NPPR-On the computational nature of emotions: insights from metareasoning and transformers. *Neuropsychopharmacology*. Accepted

Chen, J., Huys, Q. J. M., Stringaris, A., & Nielson, D. M. (2023). On the misery of cognitive effort. *PsyArXiv*. Published online March 05, 2023. doi: <https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/r9e4j>

Peciña, M., **Chen, J.**, Karp, J.F., Dombrovski, A.Y. (2023). Dynamic Feedback Between Antidepressant Placebo Expectancies and Mood. *JAMA Psychiatry*, 80(4):389-398. doi: 10.1001/jamapsychiatry.2023.0010. PMID: 36857039; PMCID: PMC9979016.

Peciña, M., **Chen, J.**, Lyew, T., Karp, J. F., & Dombrovski, A. Y. (2021). μ -Opioid Antagonist Naltrexone Partially Abolishes the Antidepressant Placebo Effect and Reduces Orbitofrontal Cortex Encoding of Reinforcement. *Biological Psychiatry: Cognitive Neuroscience and Neuroimaging*, 6(10). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.bpsc.2021.02.009>

Chen, J.*, Mizuno, A.*, Lyew, T., Karim, H. T., Karp, J. F., Dombrovski, A. Y., & Peciña, M. (2020). Naltrexone modulates contextual processing in depression. *Neuropsychopharmacology*, 45(12), 2070–2078. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41386-020-00809-2>

Peciña, M., Lyew, T., **Chen, J.**, Karp, J., and Dombrovski, A.Y. (2020) Neural Correlates of Antidepressant Expectancies Positively Moderate Antidepressant Treatment Response to Placebo but Not Escitalopram in Major Depression. *Biological Psychiatry* 87(9): S107. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.biopsych.2020.02.293>.

Brown, V. M., **Chen, J.**, Gillan, C. M., & Price, R. B. (2020). Improving the reliability of computational analyses: Model-based planning and its relationship with compulsivity. *Biological Psychiatry: Cognitive Neuroscience and Neuroimaging*, 5(6), <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.bpsc.2019.12.019>

* denotes equal contributions

Posters/Presentations

Chen, J., Nielson, D.M., Huys, Q.J.M., *Decoding Large Language Model-Quantified Emotion with MEG*. Spotlight Presentation and Poster Presentation at the Computational Psychiatry Conference (July 2025), Tübingen, Germany.

Chen, J., Nielson, D.M., Stringaris, A., Huys, Q.J.M., *Decode In-task Affect Labeling using MEG*. Oral Project Presentation at the Wellcome Centre for Human Neuroimaging (May 2023), London, United Kingdom.

Chen, J., Brown, V., Szanto, K., Dombrovski, A.Y. *Threat of Punishment Disrupts Model-Based Learning in Late-Life Depression and Suicide*. Late-breaking poster presented at the Society of Biological Psychiatry 74th Annual Scientific Conference (2019, May), Chicago, IL, and the Department of Psychiatry Research Day at University of Pittsburgh (2019, June), Pittsburgh, PA.

Chen, J., Mizuno, A., Karim, H., Lyew, T., Peciña, M. *Naltrexone modulation of contextual effects during emotional processing*. Late-breaking poster presented at the Society of Biological Psychiatry 74th Annual Scientific Conference (2019, May), Chicago, IL, and the Department of Psychiatry Research Day at University of Pittsburgh (2019, June), Pittsburgh, PA.

Peciña, M., **Chen, J.**, Lyew, T., Karp, J., Dombrovski, A.Y. *Mu opioid blockade reduces antidepressant placebo effects by disrupting corticostriatothalamic encoding of reinforcement*. Late-breaking poster presented at the Society of Biological Psychiatry 74th Annual Scientific Conference (2019, May), Chicago, IL.

Peciña, M., **Chen, J.**, Lyew, T., Karp, J., Dombrovski, A.Y. *Neuro-Computational Mechanisms Of Antidepressant Placebo Effects*. Poster presented at the Annual Meeting of the American College of Neuropsychopharmacology (2018, December), Hollywood, FL.

Chen, J., Echols, C. *Differences Between Bilinguals and Monolinguals in Executive Function Tasks: A Diffusion Model Analysis*. Poster presented at the Honors Thesis Poster Session of the University of Texas at Austin Psychology Department (2017, May), Austin, TX.

Skills

General Computer Skills: Unix and Windows NT based operating systems (user interface and command-line), Productivity suites (Microsoft Office and iWork), static and motion graphic processing and editing, web design

Programming Languages: R, Python, Matlab, Bash, HTML5, Javascript

Machine Learning: Fine-tuning Large Language Models, Classification Models (Logistic Regression, Convolution Neural Networks, Recurrent Neural Network, Transformer)

Statistical/Modeling Packages & Programs: R, STAN, PyTorch, Variational Bayesian Analysis (VBA) ToolBox, fast-dm, STATA, SPSS

Data Management Systems: RedCap, Qualtrics, mySQL

Experiment Design: PsychoPy, jsPsych

Online Data Collection Platform: Amazon MTurk, Pavlovia, Prolific

Brain Imaging Acquisition: MRI (3T), MEG, EEG

fMRI Processing and Analysis Packages: FSL and AFNI

Additional Information

Nationality: United States of America

U.K. Work Eligibility: Maximum of 20 hours per week allowed

Honors & Grants: Honors in Psychology, University Undergraduate Research Fund

Languages: English (Proficient), Cantonese (Native), Mandarin (Native), Spanish (Conversational)

Ad Hoc Reviewing: European Child & Adolescent Psychiatry, Imaging Neuroscience

Github User Profile: <https://github.com/JiazhouChen>

Google Scholar Page: <http://scholar.google.com/citations?user=WGWC4PgAAAAJ>

Research Gate Profile: https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Jiazhou_Chen3 (features recent posters)